

ADAM TERVORT

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SUMMARY

Strategic, people-centric operator with 10+ years helping an engineering-led cybersecurity company scale through high-stakes growth, complex product challenges, and major organizational transitions. Trusted partner to CEOs and technical leaders, known for building systems that create clarity, drive accountability, and keep teams aligned on the work that matters most.

Deep experience leading cross-functional initiatives across engineering, DevOps, HR, support, and product. Adept at operationalizing strategy, running after-action reviews, translating technical risk into business action, and navigating sensitive conversations that reset expectations and protect organizational focus. Equally strong in the details and the high-level view—comfortable earning credibility in technical cultures while shaping organizational rhythm, communication, and execution.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Executive Partnership & Strategic Planning
 - Accountability Systems & Operational Cadence
 - Engineering, DevOps & IT Collaboration
 - Cross-Functional Program Leadership
 - Incident & After-Action Review Facilitation
 - Internal Communications & Executive Writing
 - Organizational Architecture & Change Management
 - Performance Management & Difficult Conversations
 - Cybersecurity Market & SaaS Operations
 - Fluent in Mandarin Chinese
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SPIDEROAK

Cybersecurity SaaS | Zero-Trust Collaboration & Backup

Vice President, Operations

Aug 2022 – Present

Partnered directly with the CEO to run operational strategy, organizational planning, and execution across a distributed engineering-centric company.

- Managed day-to-day executive workflow, aligning priorities across Engineering, DevOps, IT, HR, Assurance, and Customer Success.
- Built company-wide accountability systems mapping commitments, deadlines, and decision points—improving cross-team follow-through and reducing cycle time on mission-critical initiatives.
- Led annual and quarterly strategic planning, integrating engineering, product, and GTM priorities into a unified operational roadmap.
- Conducted after-action reviews for operational failures, customer escalations, and internal process breakdowns; produced documented recommendations and implemented durable fixes.
- Co-led preparation for \$13M Series C fundraise, shaping KPI frameworks and board-level communications to align strategy and execution.
- Introduced leadership development and training programs to increase clarity, psychological safety, and upward accountability across teams.

Vice President, Customer Success

Oct 2018 – Jul 2022

- Built and led the Customer Success organization from the ground up, improving retention by 25% and directly contributing to 15% ARR growth.
- Operated as product partner to engineering and the CEO, translating customer risk and insights into roadmap decisions for mission-critical security products (CrossClave and SpiderOak One Backup).
- Authored executive-level communication and presentations for customer escalations and board updates.
- Rebuilt the company's SaaS billing and backend systems, reducing operational errors by 30% and improving revenue reliability.
- Ran sensitive performance and expectation conversations across customer-facing teams to raise the operational bar.

Customer Success Director

Jan 2017 – Sep 2018

- Implemented triage and queue systems that reduced backlog by 80% and resolution times by 60% in a highly technical support environment.
- Led integration of AI/ML-based support tooling, halving average response times and creating measurable improvements in customer experience.
- Orchestrated coordination between Support, Marketing, Sales, and Engineering during

product launches and critical incidents.

- Delivered training and documentation that elevated organizational maturity and reduced repeated operational failures.

Support Engineer

Jan 2014 – Jan 2017

- Provided deep technical support across macOS/Linux CLI, secure backup systems, encryption workflows, and account infrastructure.
 - Managed billing systems and collaborated closely with engineers to diagnose and resolve complex system issues.
 - Produced technical onboarding materials and customer education resources that reduced support load and improved adoption.
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PROJECTS & VENTURES

FREELANCE CONSULTANT

Jul 2013 – Present

- Advisor to founders across education, solar, insurance, and publishing, with projects spanning operational architecture, workflow automation, and digital system design.
 - Delivered full-stack solutions—including communications, processes, and tooling—to streamline operations and reduce manual overhead.
 - Often embedded as a fractional operator, aligning stakeholders and refocusing teams on high-leverage objectives.
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COMMUNITY & ADVISORY LEADERSHIP

RUSH CREEK LEADERSHIP TEAM

Volunteer Community Leader

Aug 2023 – Present

- Lead of day-to-day operations and strategic planning for a 375-member community organization.
- Build systems for welfare response, mentorship pipelines, and crisis management.
- Train and coach volunteer leaders, facilitating difficult conversations and resetting expectations when necessary.

KANSAS CITY JAZZ ACADEMY

Jazz Bass Instructor

Sep 2018 – Present

- Teach jazz bass and coach ensembles within a highly collaborative, feedback-driven learning environment.

MANY MOODS CHOIR & ORCHESTRA

President, Board of Directors

Jul 2014 – Jun 2020

- Oversaw governance, board operations, fundraising strategy, and large-scale event production.

EDUCATION

B.S., History

Missouri Western State University

2000 – 2005

Developed analytical, research, and communication skills foundational to leadership and operational systems design.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Programming & Data

Python (pandas) • JavaScript • HTML/CSS • REST APIs

AI & Automation

OpenAI • Claude Code • Factory Droid • Automation workflows

Web & Publishing

Static site generators • WordPress • Substack • Ghost • Beehiiv • Audio/podcast production

Collaboration & Ops

GitHub • Jira • Google Workspace • Microsoft 365 • Zoom • Slack • OKRs & EOS-style frameworks

RELEVANT CYBERSECURITY & ENGINEERING-ADJACENT EXPERIENCE

- 11 years in an engineering-led cybersecurity company supporting zero-trust architecture, secure communications, and encrypted distributed systems.
- Direct experience working with MSPs, government market partners, and high-security customers with specialized threat models.

- Operated as cross-functional liaison between engineers, product, and executives to ensure secure, predictable delivery.